THE HARVARD MBA DREAM: BUILDING A LEADERSHIP STORY BEYOND JOB TITLES

CASE STUDY STRATEGY WORKSHEET: ANIRUDH SHARMA | M7 & ELITE MBA ADMISSIONS

1. Student Persona & Challenge Diagnostic Audit

Candidate: Anirudh Sharma | Profile: Management consultant, 5 years of experience.. This worksheet outlines the systematic forensic diagnostic and strategic intervention designed to resolve this admissions roadblock.

Assessment Dimension	Diagnostic Finding & Initial Challenge	Strategic Objective
Candidate Profile	Management consultant, 5 years of experience.	Build differentiated application proposition
Core Admissions Roadblock	Anirudh wanted to apply to Harvard Business School. His professional experience included multiple client projects, but he was struggling to ...	Eliminate systemic bottlenecks through data feedback
Root Cause Identified	Misalignment between effort and strategic execution	Shift from generic repetition to targeted intervention
Admissions Target	Competitive Global / Indian MBA Program	Maximize admit ROI and scholarship potential

Key Diagnostic Insight:

"A high test score or strong resume alone is not a substitute for a coherent admissions story. Every applicant requires a personalized roadmap that aligns quantitative readiness with distinctive leadership impact." — Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee)

2. Step-by-Step Strategic Intervention

- Reviewed his academic and professional background.
- Identified experiences demonstrating ownership, initiative and leadership.
- Evaluated his personal motivations and values.
- Connected career achievements with future ambitions.
- Developed an application narrative aligned with the school's published admissions requirements and essay prompts.

3. Actionable Checklist for MBA Applicants

- Diagnostic First: Never increase preparation hours or rewrite essays without an objective diagnostic baseline.
- Data-Driven Tracking: Use targeted analytics to monitor error patterns rather than counting raw study hours.
- Holistic Narrative: Connect undergraduate background, career progression, and MBA goals into one cohesive arc.
- Expert Perspective: Involve senior mentors early to eliminate blind spots and stress-test interview responses.
- Advice: A preparation strategy must fit your reality. Consistency always beats sporadic marathons.

Considering Harvard Business School? Begin with a detailed MBA profile evaluation.

Schedule a 1-on-1 strategy session with Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee) at www.mbawizards.co.in